

Garrett Brownlee
Dr. Taylor Laemmni
SOC 4322
02/13/26

Exercise #2

As people walk through the door to the Tidwell building here on campus, I notice many things. A variety of water bottles: plastic, metal, some with lots of stickers, and some with few stickers. I also noticed people's shoes a lot. Most of the shoes on the feet on people passing me by were visibly new, but even if you could tell they're used they looked new because of how clean they were. Especially people with white shoes!. The third factor of my focus was handbags and backpacks, which can tell you quite a bit about one's class. Most of the backpacks were name-brand (L.L. Bean, Jansport, NorthFace, etc.), but every once in a while somebody walked by with a KateSpade handbag or an all-leather backpack which were salient enough to grab my attention. It was kind of hard to distinguish class based on student's clothing though, I noticed. Also, there was a lack of jewelry and watches on these students I observed.

Focusing on the water bottles that I noticed, all of them had some form of labeling or insignia on it. The people of "higher class" were drinking Evian and Essentia+ brands of water, or had stickers of the places they traveled (Hawaii, Paris, Puerto Rico). People, which I can only presume come from (or at least display the behavior of) middle class, all had cheap and plastic water bottles. These had their own spectrum too, Hillshire County brand to the brand Perrier (which is expensive, especially for a plastic bottle of water). Secondly, seeing as how new and clean the shoes of people were told me two things: they had the resources to afford that, but they also care about their expression of class. The same could be said for the handbags! As for the lack of jewelry and watches and such, I attribute that to everybody I observed being students. To me, this signified that their parents were this source of "wealth" that the students, and that these items were not likely their own. I dwelled on this thought quite a bit. Additionally interesting was the fact that clothing was so drastically different, and was not a good indicator of class, although this may be due to modern-day "norms."